



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident:	28th June 2022	Time of Incident:	09:20hrs
Region / Directorate:	GSR	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	SHW Incident Injury / Illness	EQSafe Incident Number:	27431
Actual Consequence:	Moderate	Potential Consequence:	Moderate

Incident Short Description:	Traffic controller fractured leg - stepped over storm drain to stop errant vehicle
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Executive Summary:

On 28th June 2022, a traffic controller (TC) fractured their left leg when responding to a radio call to stop an errant vehicle travelling against the traffic flow on Albany Highway.

The work site was approximately 550m long with multiple residential driveways and 3 adjoining roads, on a hill with the side roads close to the crest reducing line of sight. The Traffic Guidance Scheme (TGS) required a spotter to be present mid site to direct vehicles from residential driveways, this spotter was not present at the time of the incident. A Main Roads Maintenance Works letter to residents provided in a letter drop stated, *"will be guided onto Albany Highway with traffic control assistance, if necessary."*

A TC located at the northern end of the work site communicated via a UHF radio that a vehicle had exited a residential driveway and was headed South towards oncoming vehicles released by the southern end TC. The approved emergency communication procedure was not used. The controller requested that the errant vehicle be stopped by the TCs controlling the side roads and re-directed to a side road to avoid oncoming vehicles.

The TC on the closest intersection left their E-Stop and ran across grassed verge stepping / jumping over a 450mm deep V-drain with intent to wave the errant vehicle down. Losing their footing on the up-hill slope, they fell and immediately felt pain in their left leg. First aid was provided, but the injury resulted in severe pain on attempts to move the TC. An ambulance was called to provide medical assistance and transportation to hospital where a fracture was identified.

The fall of the injured TC resulted in them being on the edge of the road pavement of the intersection, the TC truck was placed to protect the injured TC from passing vehicles until the ambulance arrived.

It was found the TC tasked with spotting the residential driveways had left site with the TC Lead (relief spotter) to commence set up for the next work site, this action increased risk of interaction between vehicles exiting residential driveways into the controlled worksite and other vehicles travelling through the work site.

Incident Photos:



Worksite



Path of travel of TC to stop errant vehicle

Contributing Factors:

- Procedural compliance / task planning - Failed risk awareness from TC Lead to remove the spotter from the task required by the TGS without assessment or approvals
- Communication - Failure to follow approved emergency procedures for errant vehicles, requested direct action from other TCs
- Environmental – grassed verge and V-drain, slip, trips and falls.
- Injured TC failed to identify personal risk of running across grass verge and V-drain – task oriented

Corrective Actions:

- Traffic Management Plans and TGS' to be followed unless risk assessment completed, and changes approved
- TC Sub-contractor to reinforce emergency protocols for communicating unwanted events
- SWMS Risk assessment to include uneven ground and other obstructions.
- Main Roads letter to residences affected by works to be reviewed
- Findings to be communicated to all workers via toolbox and pre-start meetings

Additional Issues/Learnings:

- Focus / tunnel vision of TC acting on completing sudden change of task, not assessing risk of situation such as environment or risk to self.
- Conducting a risk assessment seeking approval when changing the requirement for a spotter contrary to the TGS, may have prevented the incident.



Critical Risk:

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to **Interaction with Live Traffic.**

Distribution of Notice:

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations